Imperfectly Matched

By Eric Benson

Suggested Roles: ***Actress*** *– April (early 20s), Evil Counter Woman*
Actor *– Zack (early 20s), Grandma, Game Show Host*

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

APRIL: **(Pg 21-28)** Yeah, can I get a large, non-fat iced mocha with three shots? Thanks.

ZACK: *(runs into APRIL as she is picking up her drink, spilling it all over her)* Oh, crap. Oh, wow. I am so sorry. Jeez. *(helping her to clean up without much success)*

APRIL: Really, it's okay. Seriously. It's not a big deal.

ZACK: *(sort of chuckling)* Well, it could be worse. You could have gotten a hot mocha and right now you'd have steaming hot coffee and milk all over you.

APRIL: Yeah, that's hilarious, man. Real funny.

ZACK: Just imagine, second, maybe third-degree burns, all because some doofus. . .

APRIL: Doofus?

ZACK: Yeah, doofus, 'cause some doofus runs into you. I'm sorry, I'm Zack.

APRIL: Charmed, I'm sure . . . April.

ZACK: April, how about I make it up to you by taking you out for a drink on Friday?

APRIL: That's a very nice offer, Zack, but I --

ZACK: Don't drink, I'm sorry. Not coffee, how about a tea date? Iced, of course.

APRIL: No, I --

ZACK: Boyfriend? **APRIL:** No

ZACK: Husband? **APRIL:** No

ZACK: Hmm . . . nun? You don't look like a nun.

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APRIL: I'm not a nun. I just don't typically go out on dates with clumsy . . . doofuses who spill my mocha all over me. Were you gonna offer me another one?

ZACK: Oh crap, I'm a doofus . . . Can I get another large

APRIL: Non-fat

ZACK: Mocha with three

APRIL: Freeze.

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR: *Meet April and Zack . . .*
ACTRESS: *A chance meeting at a coffee shop – that's how the best relationships start, isn't it -- by chance?*
ACTOR: *(scoffs) By chance is better that on a dating site! When you meet in person you can tell if there's chemistry right away.*
ACTRESS: *One little thing, one choice or accident or joke can change our lives forever – (blissful sigh) Chemistry. . .*
ACTOR: *But is "chemistry" enough to save a relationship when you are . . .*
TOGETHER: *Imperfectly Matched by Eric Benson*

APRIL: *(to audience)* So, Zack over here turned out to be a real psycho. Unfortunately, I'd given him my number, and even more unfortunately he started calling me in the middle of the night

ZACK: Hello, April, what are you wearing?

APRIL: Ew. *(slams down the phone)* His favorite was the chicken calls.

ZACK: *(Making loud chicken sounds)* Hello, April, you make me want to lay an egg.

APRIL: Freak. *(slams the phone down again; to audience)* He ended up stalking me and showing up at my door in a giant chicken costume. He kidnapped me, took me to KFC and threatened to put me in the fry vat. Claimed it would consummate our love. I testified and he's doing twenty. I'll be in therapy for at least that long. *(beat)* I'm lying. Zack and I have been together for the last three years. But, he does do that chicken thing sometimes. I had to do the big "meet his family" dinner a couple of months after we started dating.

ZACK: You are totally going to love my family, especially my grandma. And, more importantly, they are going to adore you. Just like I do. *(gives her a peck on the cheek)*

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APRIL: Well, if they're half as strange as you are, Clucker. *(to audience)* So, Zack's grandma, she, hmm . . .

******* Grandma Scene*******

GRANDMA: How do you like the meatloaf, dear?

APRIL: It's wonderful, thank you.

GRANDMA: You're an awfully skinny girl. You don't have an eating disorder, do you?

APRIL: No, no. . . just a high metabolism.

GRANDMA: Well, I just want the best for our little Pookie-Bottom.

APRIL: Well, yes, Pookie-Bottom is a special boy.

GRANDMA: I'll say he is. April, are you Catholic?

APRIL: Well, ma'am, actually our family is Jewish.

(GRANDMA has just taken a bite of scrumptious meatloaf and begins choking violently. She is wheezing and making all sorts of unpleasant noises. APRIL performs the Heimlich and the offending piece of meatloaf is successfully ejected.)

GRANDMA: Well, at least you don't look Jewish. Have you and Zack talked about remaining chaste before --

APRIL: Freeze. *(to audience)* You can't hold somebody's family against them. Even if their Grandmother does closely resemble Norman Bates' mother.

******** Present Day********

ZACK: April's family isn't . . . around. I just wanted her to feel like she had a family to be a part of. After all, she's changed my life

APRIL: Zack . . .

ZACK: Don't Zack me. I'm not ashamed to say that you've made me complete. You know that. You laugh at all my stupid jokes. You make sure my head is screwed on every morning . . . 'cause you know I'd forget it at home if you didn't. I never thought I'd meet the perfect girl. . . and then I spilled an Iced Mocha all over her.

APRIL: *(to audience)* Zack's an artist. He gave me a painting he'd done of me and then . . . took me to France for our first anniversary. If you looked up ***extravagant*** in the dictionary, the definition would include his mug shot. I got food poisoning from an evil cream puff

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and was sick for the last three days. Zack lost his wallet, my wallet, our plane tickets, our passports . . .

ZACK: That's about it.

APRIL: We were on some bargain airline where the evil counter woman didn't seem to speak English. It was an interesting experience.

******** Airport Scene********

ZACK: I lost our tickets, and we don't have our ID's. Our flight is today.

EVIL COUNTER WOMAN: Parlez vous Francais?

ZACK: We're trying to fly home.

EVIL COUNTER WOMAN: Parlez vous Francais?

ZACK: We need to go home. My girlfriend is sick.

EVIL COUNTER WOMAN: Parlez vous Francais?

ZACK: No, I don't speak French. We have a flight to Connecticut.

EVIL COUNTER WOMAN: I am not deaf, Monsieur. I am an evil counter woman.

******** Present Day********

APRIL: *(to audience)* We ended up spending 23 hours in the airport before we got on our flight.

ZACK: *(to audience)* That was a great trip.

APRIL: Basically, Zack and I are opposite in every way. I like to stay home.

ZACK: I like to go out.

APRIL: I like having everything organized. I'm kind of a neat freak.

ZACK: Why waste time putting clothes away when you're just going to wear them again?

APRIL: I like to talk things through.

ZACK: I morph into the chicken. *(chicken sounds, beat)* And so, we're living proof that opposites attract.

APRIL: Or, we're living proof that the less alike you are, the sooner the problems start to rear their ugly little heads.

ZACK: That's an exaggeration, April. C'mon, now . . .

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APRIL: *(to audience)* Sometimes I'd fantasize that we were contestants on a game show called, "Who's the Crappiest Couple?"

*******Game Show Scene*******

GAME SHOW HOST: How many times do you and your boyfriend fight per week?

APRIL: Six out of seven days?

GAME SHOW HOST: How do you typically handle disagreements?

APRIL: Well, I try to discuss things with

ZACK: She starts screaming at me

APRIL: I start trying to explain how I'm feeling and . . .

ZACK: Then I usually fall asleep.

GAME SHOW HOST: Another point for Crappy Couple #1! And, finally, when was the last time you . . .

ZACK: Oh, well. . . umm . . .

APRIL: I, uh, hmm . . .

GAME SHOW HOST: We have our winners! Please proceed to the podium to accept the Grand Prize! One full year of free relationship counseling!

APRIL: Freeze.

******** Present Day********

APRIL: *(to audience)* I actually suggested counseling and Zack, well --

ZACK: I don't want to talk about our problems with anyone

APRIL: Yeah, including me.

ZACK: That's not what I meant, April.

APRIL: It's what you said. *(to audience)* Things went down-hill from there. It seemed like we were seeing less and less of each other. We were both working or he was asleep when I got home. One night, I was sitting in the dark, at the kitchen table when he got home.

*******Break Up Scene*******

ZACK: Why don't you have the lights on?

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APRIL: Because I'm thinking.

ZACK: You can only think in the dark now? Are you crying, April?

APRIL: I thought you were coming home tonight. I thought we were going to eat dinner together.

ZACK: I'm sorry. Things got busy at the restaurant. I . . .

APRIL: You could have called. You never call

ZACK: And you always tell me I'm wrong. I just want to make you happy.

APRIL: But you don't. Freeze. *(to audience)* I asked him to take some of his stuff to his parents' house that night. We, uh, broke up.

ZACK: *(to audience)* Separated.

APRIL: *(to Zack)* Yeah, Zack, separated, permanently. Zack, we can't be together anymore. We aren't good anymore together. I make you miserable, you don't even want to be around me. Zack. . . what are you doing?

ZACK: I'm searching for my heart, April. I've lost it. It's gone somewhere and I don't know how to find it. Do you understand that?

APRIL: I can't fix us.

ZACK: I never asked you to. I just wanted us to be happy. You were happy for a long time.

APRIL: I don't think I ever really was. I thought I could be, but I'm not.

ZACK: Let's just try again . . . please. I love you.

APRIL: I don't love you, Zack. I'm sorry.

ZACK: I don't believe you. I don't think you're this cold.

APRIL: No, if I was cold, I'd let you stay with me . . . pretend that I loved you when I don't. You deserve a lot more than that.

ZACK: I'll never love anyone again, April. Did I show you my new painting?

APRIL: That's a blank canvas, Zack.

ZACK: It's white like the plate after you ate my heart.

APRIL: If I could change this I would, Zack. I don't have a magic wand. I can't love you like that. I hope you can forgive me. I know you're strong enough. I need to go, Zack. Freeze. *(to*

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audience) I don't think we can control our hearts. Whether we're falling in love, or out of it. It's just that falling in is the best feeling in the world and falling out hurts. It's funny, but one little thing, one little choice or accident or joke can change our lives forever.

*******Flashback Scene*******

APRIL: Yeah, can I get a large, non-fat iced mocha with three shots?

ZACK: Oh, crap. Oh, wow. I'm so sorry, Jeez.

APRIL: Really, it's okay, seriously. It's not a big deal.

ZACK: I'm such a doofus. Well, you have a nice day.

APRIL: Yeah, you too.

ZACK: Bye.

APRIL: Bye.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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